

An Introduction

My name is Bobbie Parr _____, and I grew up near Wabigoon, in Northwestern Ontario — a small community on the highway between Kenora and Dryden, where the land shapes how you think about what you need and who you depend on. I hold a degree in Recreation Management and Community Development from the University of Manitoba, with a minor in Indigenous Studies. But the question of who owns and controls community infrastructure was forming long before any classroom — rooted in watching what happens when the tools a community depends on belong to someone else.

The work is called Codetry. At its simplest, it is a practice for communities that want to name and build their own digital tools — and keep them. Not rely on outside platforms that can be taken away, priced out of reach, or changed without notice. Codetry is a method: a set of naming rules and structural boundaries that make sure each tool is understandable, teachable, and owned by the people who use it.

What I know about building from nothing, I learned outside any classroom. I built the 807 Food Co-operative from the ground up — a working co-op running buying rounds, producer payouts, and member tiering for food producers and buyers across Northwestern Ontario. I run a food business and maintain a homestead. I homeschool my family. The Codetry tools grew out of that daily reality — a homeschool companion that works without internet, a savings and chore tracker for kids, a bulletin board for sixty Wabigoon area families. Each one scoped, named, and documented under the same discipline. Each one stays with the people who use it.

There is a conviction that has been with me for a long time and will not quiet: communities that have been managing their own land, trade, and governance for generations should not be running their households and economies on infrastructure that somebody else controls — and can change, price out of reach, or take away. Codetry is a way to change that from the inside, not by importing a new vendor, but by building knowledge and tools together, in plain language, documented well enough that the next person in your community can carry it forward without me in the room.

What I am looking for is a conversation. I want to understand what your community is already managing, where the friction is, and whether there is a natural starting point we could build together. Not a transaction — a relationship. If there is a pilot that makes sense, we will find it together.

